

# Cindy Cui

Staff Scientist / Tech Lead | Causal Inference, Experimentation, Marketplace, Team Leadership

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**Summary:** Economist and hands-on science leader with 10+ years in causal inference, experimentation, and marketplace economics across Amazon, Netflix, and Uber. Track record of setting company-wide methodology standards, growing strong quantitative teams, and shaping product and investment decisions at the executive level.

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## EXPERIENCE

### Uber Technologies, Inc., Seattle, WA

**Staff Scientist / Tech Lead** | October 2024 – Present

- Owns the pricing and incentive strategy for airport mobility marketplace, including structural models (base price), driver offer pricing, and rider session pricing, to improve reliability and accelerate trip/revenue growth
- Built measurement foundations and experimentation standards for network-effect initiatives — including KPI frameworks, guardrails, and causal ROI evaluation across cross-platform (e.g., rides vs. eats) investments
- Created Uber's first airport competitive intelligence data products, establishing real-time market and price competitiveness signals now used by senior leadership for planning, investment, and deal negotiations
- Established experiment meta-analysis framework that reshaped resource prioritization and became the analytical foundation for senior leadership business reviews

### Netflix, Inc., Seattle, WA / Los Gatos, CA

**Senior Data Scientist / Tech Lead** | June 2021 – October 2024

- Set company-wide quality-of-experience strategy spanning Streaming, Ads, Live, and Cloud Gaming — directly shaping launch readiness, investment tradeoffs, and long-term ecosystem health decisions
- Unified user insights by integrating surveys, in-product metrics, and LLM-based analysis of customer service contacts, creating a durable and robust decision system for engineering/infra investments prioritization
- Designed scalable analytical frameworks and self-serve tooling that expanded decision-making access across engineering, product, and business teams — reducing ad-hoc analytics load while improving consistency
- Advanced experimentation and causal inference capabilities in streaming engineering, introducing methods that expanded decision scope and incorporated strategic tradeoffs, while preserving statistical rigor
- Quantified customer willingness-to-pay for quality-of-experience improvements, directly influencing subscription tiering, pricing, and investment tradeoffs
- Defined data science hiring and evaluation standards; managed and developed senior and junior talent, scaling organizational quality through structured mentorship, intern-to-FTE conversion programs, and calibrated performance coaching

### Amazon, Seattle, WA

**Senior Economist** | June 2016 – June 2021

- Led development of RL-based experimentation platforms, enabling scalable and cost-effective optimization in product recommendation algo
- Created and scaled causal models measuring brand trust and badge impact, influencing Amazon Choice launch strategy and long-term customer trust tradeoffs (organic search vs. sponsored products)
- Built and deployed downstream causal impact models for engagement optimization, serving non-retail business needs such as Alexa, Amazon Music, and Prime Video
- Built automated causal systems quantifying external shock impacts, providing data-driven insights to finance and business leaders on OKR tracking and goal setting
- Designed and implemented experiments for pricing and selection optimization in Prime Now worldwide operations; conducted customer segmentation analyses identifying key profit drivers and growth levers

### Capital One, Plano, TX

### **Senior Statistician** | June 2015 – August 2015

- Enhanced credit underwriting models by incorporating temporal features including seasonality and macroeconomic cycles, enabling \$5M incremental lending capacity while maintaining risk standards
- Designed innovative retirement-linked credit card rewards program; recognized with 1st place in company-wide innovation case competition

### **RAND Corporation**, Arlington, VA

#### **Summer Associate** | April 2014 – August 2014

- Collaborated with senior economists on healthcare policy research, and published research on early impact of the Affordable Care Act implementation

### **Clarity Services, Inc.**, Tampa, FL

#### **Research Associate** | March 2014 – September 2014

- Conducted econometric analyses of national subprime lending data, and research on financial regulation impacts
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## **EDUCATION**

### **The University of Texas at Austin**

- Ph.D. in Economics | 2016. Fields: Public Finance, Health Economics, Applied Econometrics
- M.S. in Economics | 2012

### **Peking University, Beijing, China**

- B.A. in Economics, Minor in International Relations | 2010
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## **PUBLICATIONS**

**What is the Rationale for an Insurance Coverage Mandate? Evidence from Workers' Compensation Insurance**, *American Economic Review*, 2022

Examined conditions under which mandates effectively address adverse selection and moral hazard in insurance markets

**Cash on Hand and Demand for Credit**, *Empirical Economics*, 2017

Analyzed financial decision-making under liquidity constraints using EITC refund timing and subprime credit data

**Early Marketplace Enrollees Were Older and Used More Medication than Later Enrollees**, *Health Affairs*, 2015

Provided early empirical evidence on ACA marketplace risk selection using large-scale prescription claims data

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## **PRESENTATIONS**

**Industry Conferences:** Netflix Causal Inference Summit (2024), American Causal Inference Conference (2024), Amazon Economist Seminar Series, ML Conference, Research Scientist Summit (2018–2019)

**Academic Conferences:** STATA Texas Empirical Micro Conference, APPAM, National Tax Association, ASHEcon, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas

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## **TECHNICAL SKILLS**

**Programming & Tools:** Python, PySpark, SQL, R, Stata

**Core Competencies:** Causal Inference & Experimentation Design, Pricing & Marketplace Dynamics, Machine Learning & Econometrics, Consumer Behavior Modeling, Statistical Methodology

**Leadership:** Cross-functional team leadership, strategic influence at executive level, technical mentorship, organizational talent development